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Financial reports and audited financial statements, and reports of the Board of Auditors: United Nations peacekeeping operations

Administrative and budgetary aspects of the financing of the United Nations peacekeeping operations

Implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2022

Report of the Secretary-General

Summary

The present report provides information in response to the recommendations of the Board of Auditors contained in its report on United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period from 1 July 2021 to 30 June 2022 ([A/77/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II). The report is submitted in accordance with paragraph 7 of General Assembly resolution [48/216 B](#), in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables.

The Administration has concurred with the Board's recommendations and its relevant comments have been duly reflected in the report of the Board. The present report provides additional comments from the Administration, where appropriate, and information on the status of implementation, the department responsible, the estimated completion date and the priority for each recommendation contained in the report of the Board. In addition, the report contains updated information on the status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board relating to the prior periods that were reported by the Board, in annex II to its report, as not having been fully implemented.



I. Introduction

1. In its resolution [48/216](#) B, the General Assembly requested the Secretary-General, at the same time as the recommendations of the Board of Auditors are submitted to the Assembly, to provide it with his responses and to indicate measures that will be taken to implement those recommendations, with appropriate timetables. The present report is submitted in response to the recommendations of the Board contained in its report on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2022 ([A/77/5](#) (Vol. II), chap. II).

2. In preparing the present report, account was taken of the provisions of the following documents:

(a) General Assembly resolution [52/212](#) B, in particular paragraphs 2 to 5 thereof, and the note by the Secretary-General transmitting the proposals of the Board for improving the implementation of its recommendations approved by the Assembly ([A/52/753](#), annex);

(b) Paragraph 6 of General Assembly resolution [76/235](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to ensure the full implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the related recommendations of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions in a prompt and timely manner;

(c) Paragraph 9 of General Assembly resolution [76/235](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to continue to indicate an expected time frame for the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors and the priorities for their implementation, including the office holders to be held accountable and measures taken in that regard;

(d) Paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [76/235](#) B, in which the Assembly requested the Secretary-General to provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken.

3. With regard to prioritization, the Administration noted that the Board had categorized 16 of the 20 recommendations for the period ended 30 June 2022 as “main recommendations”. While all the accepted recommendations of the Board will be implemented in a timely manner, the main recommendations are considered to be of the highest priority.

4. The status of implementation of the new recommendations as of February 2023 is summarized in tables 1 and 2.

5. As indicated in table 1, of the 16 main recommendations issued by the Board, closure has been requested for 2 and the other 14 remained under implementation as of February 2023. Of the 14 main recommendations that were under implementation, 3 have been targeted for implementation before the end of 2023 and 11 before the end of 2024.

Table 1
Status of implementation of the main recommendations of the Board of Auditors as of February 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	8	–	2	6	6	–
Department of Operational Support	4	–	–	4	4	–
Multiple entities	4	–	–	4	4	–
Total	16	–	2	14	14	–

6. As indicated in table 2, of the 20 recommendations issued by the Board, closure was requested for 3 and 17 remained under implementation as of February 2023. Of the 17 recommendations that were under implementation, 4 have been targeted for implementation before the end of 2023 and 13 before the end of 2024.

Table 2
Status of implementation of all recommendations (including main ones) of the Board of Auditors as of February 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Not accepted</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	11	–	3	8	8	–
Department of Operational Support	4	–	–	4	4	–
Multiple entities	5	–	–	5	5	–
Total	20	–	3	17	17	–

II. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors

7. The information requested by the General Assembly on the status of implementation of recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the financial period ended 30 June 2022 (A/77/5 (Vol. II), chap. II) is set out below. As indicated in the summary of the present report, most of the Administration's comments have already been included in the report of the Board. Accordingly, additional comments are provided only where deemed necessary.

8. The Board noted the positive developments in the field of enterprise risk management in the Secretariat, for example, that risk management, when effectively implemented, helps improve the resilience, effectiveness and efficiency of peacekeeping operations. The Board stated that enterprise risk management could be seen as the overarching tool covering the largest possible variety of risks and professionalizing pre-existing risk management practices. As highlighted by the Board in its report, throughout crises in particular, risk management has already emerged as a key element in informed decision-making.

9. The Board issued eight recommendations (set out in paras. 10 to 26 below) aimed towards further strengthening enterprise risk management in peacekeeping operations. The Administration accepts the Board's recommendations and will continue to work to streamline the enterprise risk management process and develop risk-based approaches to strengthen the effectiveness of peacekeeping operations.

10. In paragraph 50 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration organize an annual "peacekeeping risk management day", in order to raise awareness and develop, including through proper brainstorming and training sessions, a more risk-aware culture in the peacekeeping missions.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2024

11. The Administration will explore the process of establishing an annual peacekeeping risk management day in order to raise awareness and develop a more risk-aware culture in the peacekeeping missions.

12. In paragraph 75 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide, with the view to building a more consensual, sound and practical basis for risk-taking in peacekeeping operations, the appropriate elements to fuel a strategic discussion at the level of the legislative bodies, not excluding the issuance of a peacekeeping risk appetite statement and the revision of the 2011 risk management policy.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

13. The Administration accepts the recommendation and will be guided by the Board's findings. The Administration agrees with the Board that "the adoption of an overarching statement on risk appetite, with a vague wording, could appear of limited use to managers in determining risk priorities and having to take urgent informed decisions" (para. 61 of the Board's report) and, indeed, for that reason and fully in line with International Organization for Standardization standard ISO 31000 (guidelines on risk management), the Secretariat has adopted risk criteria specifying, as the Board correctly notes, "the amount and type of risk that the entity can or cannot take in relation to the objectives" in order to guide management in the risk assessment and prioritization process.

14. Regarding the concept of risk tolerance, the Administration wishes to further underscore that, in accordance with General Assembly resolution [66/257](#) of 9 April 2012, the Assembly is responsible for determining the risk tolerance of the Organization.

15. In paragraph 76 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration progressively develop mechanisms to define acceptable risk-

taking at the level of peacekeeping missions and experiment with ways to better incentivize and reward it.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

16. The Administration accepts the recommendation but believes that the development of mechanisms for defining acceptable risk-taking and experimenting with ways to better incentivize and reward it remains complex in the context of the United Nations Secretariat.

17. In paragraph 116 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration better promote risk-based approaches to peacekeeping through annual bottom-up feedback sessions on key risk and crisis management cases.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

18. In regular bottom-up feedback sessions, the Administration will continue to work closely with the peacekeeping missions on key risk and crisis management cases. A three-day session, bringing together risk practitioners and focal points from the Organization's field operations, was held at the Global Service Centre in Brindisi, Italy, in February 2023. Similar events will continue to be held regularly.

19. In paragraph 139 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration clarify the roles of the first and second lines of defence in the management of risks in peacekeeping operations, taking concrete steps to increase their empowerment, involvement and accountability, and formalizing in particular the participation of the Department of Peace Operations to the second line of defence.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Department of Peace Operations

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2024

20. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will review and update the enterprise risk management and internal control policy document to provide clearer guidelines on the roles of the first and second lines of defence. The Department will also review and update the terms of reference for various roles associated with enterprise risk management in line with the updated policy guidelines.

21. In close coordination with the Department of Peace Operations, the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will work on developing an updated governance structure which shall include the participation of the Department of Peace Operations in the second line of defence, while being mindful that the responsibility for ensuring an effective risk and control environment within each mission rests with the individual heads of missions. The Department of Peace Operations will support the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance in performing its role in the second line of defence by providing strategic guidance on the impact of risks on mandate delivery. It should be noted that the related activities will be prioritized based on available resources.

22. In paragraph 168 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration assign the responsibility of Chief Risk Officer (CRO) to an existing senior executive in each entity at the department, missions and service centres levels.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

23. Further to the Administration's comments contained in paragraphs 20 and 21 above relating to the recommendation set out in paragraph 139 of the Board's report, the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will engage with the responsible stakeholders to review the current enterprise risk management roles and functions, with a view to developing the role of chief risk officer to be assigned to one of the senior leadership roles in the missions.

24. In paragraph 171 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review in the coming months, through a process including all stakeholders, the quality of the existing "risk registers" and "risk treatment and response plans".

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance; and all peacekeeping missions

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2024

25. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will take the lead in developing appropriate mechanisms to support missions in the quality control of risk registers and risk treatment and response plans. Heads of missions are responsible for the preparation and quality of their entity's risk register and risk treatment and response plans. The Department of Peace Operations and the Department of Operational Support will be involved, where appropriate, in efforts to support missions in this process. It should be noted that a task force under the management committee is responsible for leading efforts to implement the Secretariat's risk register and risk treatment and response plans with the advice and support of the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance. It should

also be noted that the related activities will be prioritized based on available resources.

26. In paragraph 204 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct a thorough review of all the existing accountability requirements on peacekeeping operations, in order to streamline and reduce the burden on managers (“simplification shock”) as well as to better articulate risk management with key internal control, strategic programming, budgeting and performance frameworks and ensure data sharing and interconnected information systems.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

27. It is to be noted that the articulation of risk management with key internal controls has been initiated through the integration of the internal control framework and the risk registers for peacekeeping operations. It is anticipated that some peacekeeping operations will be migrated to the governance, risk and compliance (GRC) system in the course of 2023.

28. The Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance will continue to work with all the other components of the accountability system to streamline the enterprise risk management process and develop risk-based approaches to strengthen the resilience, effectiveness and efficiency of peacekeeping operations.

29. The Administration will continue its discussions with the Board on how the recommended simplification shock could be applied.

30. In paragraph 222 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration issue a standard operating procedure (SOP) for cross-borrowing starting with the cash shortfall identification and ending with the loan movement in Umoja. This standard operating procedure shall also include a template note with all relevant information for the approval. Finally, the standard operating procedure should provide that the heads of missions affected are informed.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2023

31. The documentation of the process in the form of a standard operating procedure, in accordance with the General Assembly resolution [76/272](#), is under preparation. The draft standard operating procedure includes reminders that delegated authority for the management of liquidity and loans approval remains with the Controller at United Nations Headquarters. The draft standard operating procedure also details the process for review, escalation of low cash balances and the approval process for loans and repayments, as well as who needs to be notified, including the heads of missions.

32. **In paragraph 246 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration provide additional disclosure in the notes to the volume II financial statements to outline the reasons the historic balances regarding the United Nations Operation in the Congo and the United Nations Emergency Force are still being reported more than 50 years after their completion.**

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Target date: Not applicable

33. The Administration's comments were reflected in paragraph 247 of the Board's report. In addition, the disclosure of the old balances was supplemented in the notes to the volume II financial statements. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

34. **In paragraph 262 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration revise the supplemental instruction regarding inventory in order to make it fully compliant with International Public Sector Accounting Standard (IPSAS) 12, especially on the valuation methodology, and ensure that it is implemented in all missions.**

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Third quarter of 2023

35. The Administration will incorporate in the supplemental closing instructions for the financial year 2022/23 a provision for the peacekeeping missions to measure the fuel reserves at the lower of periodic weighted average price and current replacement cost. The fuel price tracker will be enhanced to support such valuation. The supplemental instructions will be promulgated before the end of March 2023.

36. The requirement to comply with the periodic weighted average price methodology and capturing all incoming fuel transactions will be further strengthened through the financial year-end engagement with the missions during the period from April to June 2023.

37. The valuation of the fuel reserves will be finalized along with the validation of the missions' submissions by August 2023.

38. **In paragraph 274 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration formalize a policy document for the actuarial valuation of employee benefits which gives an overview of the process and related internal controls. In particular, this policy should describe and document the significant decisions and assumptions to be included in the employee benefits valuation.**

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

39. As the processes and controls are already in place, the Administration will take steps to streamline and formalize them in a policy document.

40 In paragraph 285 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration systematically document the review and the update of volume II employee benefits actuarial assumptions, providing appropriate evidence as necessary, to ensure their reasonableness before using them in the valuation.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: Fourth quarter of 2024

41. While the necessary review of the actuarial assumptions is regularly carried out and its results are formalized in the actuarial assumptions letter, the Administration agrees to additionally outline the main points considered during such a review in a general document, as applicable.

42. In paragraph 293 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration complete further the information disclosed in the notes to the financial statements, as prescribed in paragraphs 141 to 149 of IPSAS 39.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Target date: Not applicable

43. The Administration supplemented volume II post-audit financial statements to enhance compliance with disclosure requirements under IPSAS 39 and requests the Board to close this recommendation.

44. In paragraph 298 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration further disclose, in the notes to the financial statements, the results of the sensitivity analyses for benefits plans for each significant actuarial assumption.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Target date: Not applicable

45. The Administration supplemented post-audit financial statements with the results of sensitivity analyses for all significant assumptions as outlined under IPSAS 39 and requests that the Board close this recommendation.

46. In paragraph 311 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration conduct at least annually a qualitative review of all Umoja user accounts and roles granted in the Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance. This review should include making the necessary modifications and deprovisioning user accounts to avoid having any active accounts with legacy privileges.

Departments responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Target date: First quarter of 2024

47. The user access functional subgroup will be establishing the process and procedural framework to support the annual review of Umoja accesses. The secretariat of the user access functional subgroup will provide the coordination required for business teams to define the framework. The respective business teams will be responsible for ensuring that the annual review is conducted for their responsible areas.

48. In paragraph 324 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration strengthen the quality check of the data entered into the digital supply chain planning tool, including by alerting missions to potential data quality issues and collaborating to resolve them, especially regarding product information descriptions and stocks.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2024

49. Data entered into the supply chain planning tool are for transactional-level activities taking place at different unit levels in client entities where the Department of Operational Support does not have any visibility for conducting real-time accuracy checks. However, as part of Headquarters support, the Office of Supply Chain Management will strengthen data quality checks through the monthly data quality check report, alerting the missions to any potential data quality issues.

50. **In paragraph 325 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration rework key performance indicators for demand planning, set targets to be reached and ensure a follow-up of the results.**

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: First quarter of 2024

51. The Administration will review and update the key performance indicators for demand planning in the context of the roll-out of the supply chain planning tool.

52. **In paragraph 349 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration complete the strategies for the nine remaining procurement categories.**

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2023

53. By the end of 2022, the Administration had completed 36 out of the 40 category strategies. The Administration is working with the relevant stakeholders to develop the remaining category strategies by the second quarter of 2023.

54. **In paragraph 350 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration set, for each strategy, appropriate implementation milestones and performance indicators in order to monitor results and take the actions necessary at the level of the Department of Operational Support and after close consultations with the peacekeeping missions.**

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Target date: Second quarter of 2024

55. The supply chain performance framework establishes key performance indicators for measuring the overall health of the supply chain of the United Nations Secretariat. The key performance indicators have been organized based on five performance attributes: responsiveness, reliability, asset efficiency, cost and agility across all categories. The framework will be updated to incorporate category-specific key performance indicators based on the approved strategies.

III. Implementation of the recommendations contained in the reports of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations for prior financial periods

56. In paragraph 10 of its resolution 76/235 B, the General Assembly requested that the Secretary-General provide, in his next report on the implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors concerning United Nations peacekeeping operations, a full explanation for the delays in the implementation of all outstanding recommendations of the Board, the root causes of the recurring issues and the measures to be taken. Such explanations have been included in the Administration's detailed comments relating to the relevant recommendations.

57. In annex II to its report on United Nations peacekeeping operations for the 12-month period from 1 July 2021 to 30 June 2022 (A/77/5 (Vol. II), chap. II), the Board provided a summary of the status of implementation of its 41 extant recommendations issued during the six prior financial periods up to 30 June 2021. Out of the 41 extant recommendations, 19 (46 per cent) were assessed as "implemented", 21 (51 per cent) as "under implementation" and 1 (3 per cent) as "overtaken by events".

58. As at 30 June 2022, the overall status of implementation of all of the Board's recommendations issued since the 2015/16 financial period up until the 2020/21 financial period (that is, over the six prior financial periods) is shown in table 3.

Table 3

Overall status of implementation of the recommendations of the Board of Auditors from six prior financial periods up to 30 June 2021

<i>Financial period</i>	<i>Report symbol</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Fully implemented</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Overtaken by events</i>
2015/16	A/71/5 (Vol. II)	55	48 (87%)	1 (2%)	6 (11%)
2016/17	A/72/5 (Vol. II)	75	66 (88%)	1 (1%)	8 (11%)
2017/18	A/73/5 (Vol. II)	52	34 (65%)	7 (14%)	11 (21%)
2018/19	A/74/5 (Vol. II)	43	40 (93%)	1 (2%)	2 (5%)
2019/20	A/75/5 (Vol. II)	30	23 (77%)	4 (13%)	3 (10%)
2020/21	A/76/5 (Vol. II)	10	2 (20%)	7 (70%)	1 (10%)
Total		265	213 (80%)	21 (8%)	31 (12%)

59. Table 4 provides a detailed analysis of the status of implementation, as at February 2023, of the 21 extant recommendations from the prior periods that had been assessed previously by the Board to be "under implementation".

Table 4

Status of implementation of the outstanding recommendations of the Board of Auditors from prior periods as of February 2023

(Number of recommendations)

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance	9	3	6	6	—
Department of Peace Operations	5	2	3	3	—

<i>Department responsible</i>	<i>Total</i>	<i>Closure requested</i>	<i>Under implementation</i>	<i>Target date set</i>	<i>No target date</i>
Department of Operational Support	3	1	2	2	–
Multiple entities	4	–	4	4	–
Total	21	6	15	15	–

60. Of the 21 recommendations that were assessed by the Board to be under implementation, the Administration has requested the closure of 6. As of February 2023, the remaining 15 were under implementation, of which 12 are targeted for implementation before the end of 2023 and 3 before the end of 2024.

A. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2016 (A/71/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

61. In paragraph 40 of its report, the Board reiterated its recommendation that the Administration review the useful lives of fully depreciated assets that are still in use.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Initial target date: Second quarter of 2018

Revised target date: Not applicable

62. The Administration completed its review of the fixed asset data in Umoja, using post-Galileo conversion data, which included all active assets, disposed assets, equipment records and asset quantities. The updated IPSAS useful lives are active in Umoja effective from 1 January 2023 for new assets along with updates to the United Nations corporate guidance and policies during 2023. The Administration requests the closure of this recommendation by the Board.

B. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2017 (A/72/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

63. In paragraph 464 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider keeping staff members available until after the liquidation date to finalize outstanding tasks.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance, Department of Operational Support
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Ongoing
<i>Revised target date:</i>	30 June 2023

64. The Administration established a surge capacity mechanism to maintain a stand-by pool of highly skilled and trained civilian personnel ready to be deployed anywhere at short notice to meet surge demands in special situations, including establishment of a new office, closure of an existing office, start-up, transitions, downsizing or liquidation, and crisis situations for the global Secretariat. The Administration will further discuss the implementation of this recommendation with the Board during its next audit.

C. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2018 (A/73/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

65. In paragraph 153 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration implement the force generation process in Umoja.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Peace Operations, Department of Operational Support and Enterprise Resource Planning Solution Division
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Ongoing
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023

66. The Administration will review the current force generation process for police and military units and map out which key decision points and documents should be registered in Umoja or another tool which can be linked to Umoja. The implementation of the force generation process in Umoja would be similar to the implementation of the recruitment of civilian staff. While not all stages of the civilian staff recruitment process are carried out within Umoja, they are carried out in a consistent manner which allows key information and steps to be recorded in Umoja. The next steps include management agreement on the scope, definition of related business requirements and submission through established change governance processes, following which a technical assessment will be undertaken.

67. In paragraph 183 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the objectives, processes and staff requirements of integrated operational teams, considering the upcoming new peace and security structure.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Closure requested
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Second quarter of 2019
Revised target date: Not applicable

68. A departmental management review of the objectives, processes and staff requirements of integrated operational teams was completed in January 2023. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

69. In paragraph 185 of its report, the Board further recommended updating the integrated operational team policy based on this review.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Fourth quarter of 2019
Revised target date: Third quarter of 2023

70. The production of guidance on integrated operational teams will be initiated upon identification of resources. If resources can be identified rapidly, it is anticipated that this will be finalized by end of September 2023.

71. In paragraph 209 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration analyse the direct and indirect costs associated with the disposal of unserviceable and expired ammunition from troop- and/or police-contributing countries and inform Members States accordingly.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support
Status: Under implementation
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Ongoing
Revised target date: Second quarter of 2024

72. The Administration determined that the recommended analysis would entail in-depth technical knowledge and expertise on ammunition, which is currently not available in the United Nations Secretariat. As a result, the Office of Supply Chain Management in the Department of Operational Support explored different options for outsourcing such expertise including through soliciting assistance from Member States, which has yet to materialize. In the absence of these resources, the Administration will form a working group, comprising United Nations Headquarters and mission staff and complete the study by the second quarter of 2024.

73. In paragraph 375 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration consider publishing tenders for goods and services instead of publishing solely the request for expression of interest.

Department responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Initial target date: Ongoing

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

74. The recommendation is in the process of being implemented. Phase 2 of the United Nations Global Marketplace -Ariba interface is due to be completed by the end of March 2023. Once phase 2 is completed, the feasibility and implementation timeline for phase 3 of the interface will be re-evaluated and finalized.

75. In paragraph 407 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration amend the policy for rosters with the objective to facilitate roster building, management and data cleansing.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: Medium

Initial target date: Third quarter of 2019

Revised target date: Fourth quarter of 2023

76. In accordance with General Assembly mandates, inter alia, under Assembly resolution [70/286](#), the Secretariat builds, maintains and manages global rosters in response to being urged “to make every effort to reduce the recruitment lead time for staff in field missions”. While the roster management system had undergone continuous updates and improvements in 2021, as confirmed by a recommendation of the Board of Auditors, the Secretariat embarked on a restructuring of the system with the aim of standardizing operational aspects of roster building, association and management. This entails, inter alia, the provision of detailed roster-related guidance to users, reassessing roster validity and time limitation and addressing aspects of roster diversity. The restructuring is scheduled for completion by the end of 2023.

77. In paragraph 417 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration review the recruitment process to increase transparency and simplify and shorten the procedure.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Closure requested

Priority: Medium

Initial target date: Third quarter of 2019

Revised target date: Not applicable

78. As a result of the dual effect of the current staff selection policy and the delegation of authority framework under which both hiring responsibility and

accountability are placed at entity level, the focus has been put on introducing incremental improvements in the recruitment process with the aim of making it more efficient, in accordance with, inter alia, General Assembly resolution 71/263 and as manifested in the shortening of the recruitment timeline. Those improvements have been carried out predominantly under the recruitment innovation project in place since 2019, which is both (a) bottleneck-driven in that it starts from a rigorous analysis of timelines at each stage and substage of the recruitment process and introduces improvements with the highest impact first and (b) client-centric in that priorities and needs are continuously discussed and identified together with entities. The Administration considers the recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

D. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2019 (A/74/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

79. In paragraph 202 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration extend the delegation of authority portal's functionalities to specify and limit subdelegations to ensure that the delegate is aware of the scope.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2020
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023

80. The portal enhancements are currently in the development and testing phases. The new functionalities will be released to the production environment once the revised Secretary-General's bulletin on delegation of authority is promulgated.

E. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2020 (A/75/5 (Vol. II), chap. II)

81. In paragraph 68 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine the support account share of after-service health insurance expenditure on the basis of actual costs incurred within peacekeeping operations.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2021
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023

82. As noted by the Board in its report, the United Nations Secretariat finalized the exercise in 2022 and the newly determined apportionment ratio for different funding sources, including the support account, will be considered in the context of the next budget cycle.

83. In paragraph 175 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration, together with the missions, obtain an independent analysis by a group of experts of whether the current exclusive partnership of having the Mine Action Service with the United Nations Office for Project Services (UNOPS) is cost-effective and delivering on the missions' mandates and evaluate the benefits of the Mine Action Service implementing a certain share of mine action activities itself, for example, by directly administering third-party agreements through Mine Action Service programme managers in the field.

Department responsible: Department of Peace Operations

Status: Closure requested

Priority: High

Initial target date: Second quarter of 2022

Revised target date: Not applicable

84. The independent review was conducted from May to November 2022. The report of the Secretary-General on the findings and the recommendations of the review, which has been completed, will be presented at the resumed second part of the seventy-seventh session of the General Assembly in May 2023, under the 2023/24 peacekeeping overview agenda. The Administration considers the recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

85. In paragraph 176 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration include in the new memorandum of understanding with UNOPS clear stipulations on transparency and the provision of supporting documents, on the utilization of existing United Nations contracts and structures, on the consequences of non-compliance and on the UNOPS fee structure.

Department responsible: Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Initial target date: Second quarter of 2021

Revised target date: Second quarter of 2023

86. The Administration has made substantial progress in the negotiation of the new memorandum of understanding. Notwithstanding this, discussions continue on a few remaining clauses, such as on details of fee structure and rebates, with a view to their concluding in the first half of 2023. An initial draft memorandum of understanding between the United Nations Secretariat and UNOPS, which has been agreed in the interim, is currently being reviewed by legal experts.

87. In paragraph 309 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a United Nations occupational safety and health management system that also includes COVID-19 measures.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Operational Support and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under Implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Third quarter of 2024

88. Following strategic review in 2022, the occupational safety and health management system is under progressive implementation at United Nation Headquarters and those locations having a professional safety officer to perform key occupational safety and health functions, while the framework capability of the High-level Committee on Management is being developed for those duty stations that do not have such professionals. The incident reporting technological solution has been revised and upgraded to include coronavirus disease (COVID-19) reporting.

F. Recommendations contained in the report of the Board of Auditors for the 12-month period ended 30 June 2021 ([A/76/5 \(Vol. II\)](#), chap. II)

89. In paragraph 41 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration perform cross-cutting analysis and workshops with missions to enhance feedback to missions and exchange between missions, review the number of key controls in risk control matrices, calculate the overall average maturity scale on the basis of the weighted maturity scale of each entity (e.g., budget volume) in order to determine opportunities for improvement in the statement on internal control, and assess the introduction of an electronic platform.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under Implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	Medium
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2023

90. As noted by the Board in its report, and as part of the process for the preparation of the statement on internal control for 2022, cross-sectoral consultative workshops, including with peacekeeping operations, were held in late 2022 and continue in early 2023. Key controls reflected in the 2021 risk control matrices continue to be reviewed as part of the efforts to simplify the framework and reduce the number of controls. The process control module of the SAP/GRC (governance, risk and compliance) system was successfully rolled out to pilot entities in the fourth quarter of 2022. It is anticipated that in 2023, additional entities will be included in the exercise.

91. In paragraph 51 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration define, in the financial agreements with UNOPS, the hierarchies and reporting lines between UNOPS and the Chiefs of the Mine Action Programme at the missions and expand the Secretariat's internal responsibilities

matrix to cover cases in which the Mine Action Service implements mine action activities without UNOPS.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Under Implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Third quarter of 2023

92. As noted in the Board's report, the first part of this recommendation relating to financial agreements has been completed. The implementation of the second part of the recommendation is contingent on the consideration by the General Assembly of the report of the Secretary-General on the findings and recommendation of the independent review at the resumed second part of the seventy-seventh session of the Assembly in May 2023. The target date for the implementation of the second part of this recommendation remains the third quarter of 2023.

93. In paragraph 57 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration determine which categories of assets the missions shall provide to UNOPS for mine action projects and exclude them from financial agreements with UNOPS, include provisions on periodic asset reporting by UNOPS that facilitate IPSAS financial reporting in the new memorandum of understanding, and integrate the Chiefs of the Mine Action Programme into the oversight and management of project assets.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations and Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
Status: Under implementation
Priority: High
Initial target date: Third quarter of 2023

94. As noted in the Board's report, the first part of this recommendation has been completed. The second part of the recommendation is in progress: Negotiations on the new memorandum of understanding between the United Nations Secretariat and UNOPS are ongoing, as indicated in paragraph 86 above. The third part of the recommendation, in which the Mine Action Service has finalized and rolled out the standard operating procedures on asset management for mine action programmes, which includes roles and responsibilities for the Chiefs of the Mine Action Programme, has been completed. The target date for the implementation of the remaining parts of this recommendation remains the third quarter of 2023.

95. In paragraph 61 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration specify in one central catalogue document which activities fall under the scope of the Mine Action Service.

Departments responsible: Department of Peace Operations
Status: Closure requested
Priority: Medium
Initial target date: Third quarter of 2023
Revised target date: Not applicable

96. The catalogue has been completed and is now posted on the Mine Action Service website. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

97. In paragraph 74 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration ensure that the delegation of authority to any Officers-in-Charge is visible in the delegation of authority portal, and define and codify the delegation of authority for administrative decisions regarding the management of resources, including human resources, for all drawdown and liquidation activities after the Security Council mandate of a mission has ended.

<i>Department responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Under implementation
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	Fourth quarter of 2022
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Second quarter of 2023

98. The revised Secretary-General's bulletin [ST/SGB/2019/2/Rev.1](#), which is in the final review stage, will address this recommendation by (a) including a new disposition stating that in the case that an officer-in-charge arrangement is put in place to assume the function held by an official whose post has become vacant, the authorities will be delegated to the officer-in-charge in the online portal until the successor or the acting officer is appointed; and (b) also including a new section that will clarify the exercise of temporary delegated authority at the closure of operations of an entity.

99. In paragraph 95 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration promulgate a human resources downsizing policy for drawdown and liquidation.

<i>Departments responsible:</i>	Department of Management Strategy, Policy and Compliance
<i>Status:</i>	Closure requested
<i>Priority:</i>	High
<i>Initial target date:</i>	First quarter of 2023
<i>Revised target date:</i>	Not applicable

100. The administrative instruction on downsizing or restructuring resulting in termination of appointments ([ST/AI/2023/1](#)) was issued in January 2023. The Administration considers this recommendation to be implemented and requests its closure by the Board.

101. In paragraph 134 of its report, the Board recommended that the Administration establish a centralized analysing and enforcing function to perform cross-cutting analyses of missions' and services centres' property, plant and equipment and inventory holdings, to achieve economies of scale; to identify potential surplus holdings and initiate corrective actions; to ensure continuing management of asset disposal; and to eliminate disadvantages for missions and

services centres, such as having to bear transport costs when sharing surplus assets.

Departments responsible: Department of Operational Support

Status: Under implementation

Priority: High

Initial target date: Third quarter of 2024

102. The Administration stated that the recommendation is under implementation. Existing resources from within the Global Service Centre have been consolidated to create a global material life cycle management team. This team is developing a business case on strategic assets management which will be the guiding principle for the centralized role.
